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California's 'Super Sanctuary' Refuses to Help ICE With Mass Deportations

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The San Diego County Board of Supervisors has voted to prohibit the use of its resources and funding to support federal immigration agents in carrying out deportations.

President-elect Donald Trump, who is set to return to office on January 20, has pledged to implement the largest mass deportation program in U.S. history. His hard-line immigration agenda also includes shutting down the CBP One app and reinstating the "Remain in Mexico" program.

He has also promised to deport people residing in the United States legally under programs established to protect migrants who arrive from certain countries.

On Tuesday, the San Diego County board approved the measure with a 3-1 vote, while Supervisor Joel Anderson was absent.

The county is set to limit the use of its jails, county buildings and personnel in assisting federal immigration enforcement agents.

"San Diego County has always been a place where communities are valued, not divided and as a County Supervisor, I'm committed to leading a local government that promotes unity, equity, and justice for all, while upholding the law," said County Chairwoman Nora Vargas.

"We will not allow our local resources to be used for actions that separate families, harm community trust, or divert critical local resources away from addressing our most pressing challenges. Immigration enforcement is a federal responsibility, and our County will not be a tool for policies that hurt our residents," she added.

The lone oppositional vote came from Supervisor Jim Desmond, who told Newsweek: "Today's outrageous decision to turn San Diego County into a "Super" Sanctuary County is an affront to every law-abiding citizen who values safety and justice. The Board of Supervisors' 3-1 vote to embrace this radical policy is a direct betrayal of the people we are sworn to protect.

"This reckless measure not only goes far beyond California's already extreme Sanctuary State laws but actively endangers our communities by shielding illegal immigrant criminals from deportation."

San Diego County, home to 3.3 million residents and situated along the U.S.-Mexico border, stands out as one of the more notable local governments enhancing protections for undocumented immigrants.

California possesses the second-largest state Justice Department in the U.S., ensuring it is uniquely equipped to square off against Trump's new administration.

Shortly after Trump's electoral victory, Governor Gavin Newsom called a special session of the state legislature. The special session was intended to tackle a range of issues, including protecting immigrant families, ensuring reproductive freedom, safeguarding civil rights and securing California's financial interests, particularly in the face of threats to withhold federal funding.

State lawmakers have expressed concern about the implications for the state's policies, particularly on issues such as immigration, amid the threat of mass deportations.

Speaking on state efforts to protect migrants, Assemblymember Jesse Gabriel, who represents the San Fernando Valley and chairs the Assembly Budget Committee, told Newsweek: "We have listened to some of the president's rhetoric and the rhetoric of those who are around him.

"We need to be prepared, and so while we hope to collaborate. We hope that there's no need to spend any additional resources and there won't be any need for litigation."

Jim McDonnell, the new chief of the Los Angeles Police Department, told the Associated Press that his team was ready to protect migrants, adding that it had rules to prevent officers from getting involved in immigration enforcement.

Other states and counties, however, are preparing to support Trump's deportation initiatives.

A Missouri lawmaker has proposed a program that would give residents $1,000 payouts for reporting illegal immigrants in their communities to authorities.

State Senator-elect David Gregory, who put forward the bounty-hunter-style system, wants to allow bail bond agents to be certified to go after those who cross the border illegally.

Gregory introduced Senate Bill 72 on December 1, and it would also bar undocumented migrants from receiving benefits, receiving a driver's license, or becoming a legal resident of Missouri.

Trump's border czar, Tom Homan, recently issued a stark warning to Democratic lawmakers.

Homan sent a "clear message" to sanctuary cities opposing the incoming administration's stricter border policies: either get on board or step aside.

"You've got San Diego writing legislation. You've got Colorado and other states and other cities saying they're going to prevent us doing what I'm doing. I want to send a clear message. If you let us in the jail, we can arrest the bad guy in the jail and in the safety and security of the jail. One officer could do that, but when you release a public safety threat back in the community, you put the community at risk. You put my officers at risk. You put the alien at risk," he told Fox News.

Still, Democrats are rallying nationwide to oppose Trump's immigration policies, launching a wave of grassroots mobilization, legal challenges and legislative efforts aimed at protecting immigrant communities.

On Tuesday, seven leading Democratic Party senators sent a letter to President Joe Biden urging him to act now to protect migrants living in the U.S. legally.

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